BEYOND COMPLIANCE

A COMPARATIVE BRSR-BASED ESG PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS OF INDIA'S AUTOMOBILE INDUSTRY



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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting (BRSR) framework has significantly expanded the availability of non-financial data for Indian listed companies. However, the presence of disclosure alone does not ensure meaningful understanding of sustainability performance. In practice, BRSR reports are often read as compliance documents, with limited effort made to interpret the data comparatively or to assess performance outcomes across firms.

This report uses BRSR disclosures to conduct a comparative, outcome-oriented assessment of environmental and social performance within India's automobile manufacturing sector. Using intensity-based indicators and peer-relative benchmarking, the study analyses sustainability performance across four major automobile manufacturers—Tata Motors, Mahindra & Mahindra, Maruti Suzuki, and Ashok Leyland—over the period FY 2022–23 to FY 2024–25.

The analysis reveals that while all firms demonstrate compliance with BRSR requirements, sustainability performance varies considerably across both environmental and social dimensions. Improvements in greenhouse gas emission intensity are visible across the sector; however, the pace and consistency of improvement differ markedly between firms. Higher renewable energy adoption does not necessarily uniformly translate into lower emission intensity, indicating that operational efficiency and process-level interventions remain critical drivers of environmental outcomes.

On the social dimension, workforce safety, employee well-being expenditure, and gender-related indicators exhibit uneven performance and slower progress relative to environmental efficiency metrics. The integrated ESG assessment highlights imbalances in sustainability strategies, with firms often performing strongly in one dimension while lagging in others.

Overall, the findings suggest that sustainability efforts within the automobile sector remain fragmented, and that BRSR disclosures, when analyzed systematically, can provide insights that go beyond descriptive reporting. The report argues for a shift towards outcome-focused interpretation of BRSR data and highlights areas where firms can strengthen the integration of environmental efficiency and social performance to improve long-term resilience.

RATIONALE FOR CHOICE OF SECTOR



The automobile manufacturing sector was selected for this study due to its strategic importance within India's industrial economy and its direct exposure to multiple sustainability-related risks. The sector is energy-intensive, emissions-intensive, and highly dependent on a large and diverse workforce, making it a critical test case for evaluating the effectiveness of sustainability reporting frameworks such as BRSR.

From an environmental perspective, automobile manufacturing involves significant energy consumption, fuel use, and process-related emissions. The sector is also central to India's broader decarbonization agenda, particularly in the context of electric mobility and cleaner manufacturing practices.

Socially, the sector presents distinct challenges related to occupational safety, contract labour, and workforce well-being. Manufacturing operations involve high exposure to physical risk, and safety outcomes are closely linked to operational continuity and reputational risk. Gender inclusion also remains a structural challenge within the sector, particularly in shop-floor roles.

Given these characteristics, the automobile sector provides a suitable context for examining whether BRSR disclosures meaningfully capture sustainability performance outcomes, and whether reported data can be used to identify sector-wide patterns, trade-offs, and areas for improvement.

INTRODUCTION

The introduction of the BRSR framework by the Securities and Exchange Board of India marked a significant step towards standardising sustainability disclosures for listed companies. By aligning reporting requirements with the National Guidelines on Responsible Business Conduct, BRSR seeks to improve transparency, accountability, and comparability across environmental, social, and governance dimensions.

Despite these advances, challenges remain in translating disclosed information into actionable insight. BRSR reports are typically extensive and descriptive, and stakeholders often lack structured frameworks to interpret performance across companies or over time. As a result, the analytical potential of BRSR data remains underutilised.

This report addresses this gap by applying a comparative, indicator-based methodology to BRSR disclosures within the automobile manufacturing sector. By focusing on intensity-based metrics, peer benchmarking, and integrated ESG interpretation, the study aims to demonstrate how BRSR data can be used to assess performance outcomes rather than disclosure volume.

The analysis is intended not as a ranking exercise, but as a diagnostic assessment that highlights relative strengths, structural gaps, and cross-dimensional trade-offs. In doing so, the report seeks to contribute to ongoing discussions on how sustainability reporting in India can evolve from a compliance-oriented exercise to a more effective tool for performance evaluation and strategic decision-making.

COMPANY PROFILES

TATA MOTORS LIMITED

L28920MH1945PLC004520

Tata Motors is one of India's largest automobile manufacturers, with operations spanning passenger vehicles, commercial vehicles, and electric mobility solutions. The company has a diverse manufacturing footprint within India and plays a prominent role in the country's electric vehicle transition. Given its scale of operations and relatively diversified product portfolio, Tata Motors presents a relevant case for examining efficiency-driven environmental performance and the challenges associated with managing sustainability outcomes across complex organisational structures.

MAHINDRA & MAHINDRA LIMITED

L28920MH1945PLC004520

Mahindra & Mahindra operates across multiple segments, including automotive manufacturing, farm equipment, and industrial services. Within the automobile sector, the company has a strong presence in utility vehicles and commercial mobility solutions. Mahindra & Mahindra's operations are characterised by a relatively strong emphasis on workforce-related policies and social initiatives, making it an important case for analysing the interaction between social performance outcomes and environmental efficiency within manufacturing operations.

MARUTI SUZUKI INDIA LIMITED

L34103DL1981PLC011375

Maruti Suzuki India Limited is India's largest passenger vehicle manufacturer by volume and has a dominant presence in the domestic market. Its operations benefit from significant scale advantages, highly standardised manufacturing processes, and an extensive supplier ecosystem. Maruti Suzuki's market leadership and production scale make it a relevant benchmark for assessing how operational efficiency, energy use, and emission intensity evolve in high-volume manufacturing environments.

ASHOK LEYLAND LIMITED

L34101TN1948PLC000105

Ashok Leyland is a major manufacturer of commercial vehicles, with a focus on medium and heavy-duty segments. Compared to passenger vehicle manufacturers, Ashok Leyland's operations are more concentrated within commercial vehicle production, which involves different energy use patterns and safety risk profiles. The company's increasing adoption of renewable energy and focus on operational sustainability initiatives make it a useful case for analysing the relationship between transition-oriented actions and efficiency outcomes.

METHODOLOGY

STUDY DESIGN AND SCOPE

This study adopts a comparative, indicator-based approach to analyse environmental and social performance using Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting (BRSR) disclosures. The analysis focuses on four major automobile manufacturers operating in India—Tata Motors, Mahindra & Mahindra, Maruti Suzuki, and Ashok Leyland—over a three-year period from FY 2022–23 to FY 2024–25.

The objective of the methodology is not to assess absolute sustainability performance in isolation, but to evaluate relative performance within a peer group, using data that companies themselves disclose under a common regulatory framework.

DATA SOURCES

All data used in this study are derived from publicly available BRSR disclosures published by the respective companies in their annual reports. Only disclosed values were used, and no external estimates or assumptions were introduced. The analysis primarily draws from BRSR sections related to energy consumption, greenhouse gas emissions, workforce safety, employee well-being, and gender-related disclosures. To ensure consistency, only Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions were considered, as these are mandatorily reported and comparable across firms. Scope 3 emissions were excluded due to differences in reporting boundaries and data availability.

INDICATOR SELECTION AND CONSTRUCTION

Rather than relying on absolute values (such as total emissions or total energy consumption), the analysis prioritises intensity-based and outcome-oriented indicators, which allow comparison across firms of different sizes and operational scales.

The key environmental indicators include:

- Scope 1 and Scope 2 GHG emission intensity,
- Energy consumption intensity,
- Renewable energy share.

Social performance is assessed using:

- Workforce well-being expenditure as a proportion of revenue,
- Lost Time Injury Frequency Rate (LTIFR),
- Gender-related indicators derived from BRSR disclosures.

NORMALISATION AND BENCHMARKING APPROACH

To enable peer comparison, all selected indicators were normalized using a min–max scaling approach in Microsoft Excel. For each indicator, the best-performing firm within the peer group was assigned a score of 100, and the worst-performing firm was assigned a score of 0, with intermediate values scaled proportionally. This normalization was applied consistently across indicators for the primary analysis year (FY 2024–25).

It is important to note that these scores represent relative performance within the selected peer group, not absolute sustainability adequacy.

VISUALISATION AND ANALYTICAL FRAMEWORK

Comparative performance was examined using scatter plots to assess relationships between environmental and social outcomes, as well as between GHG emission intensity and renewable energy adoption, with median reference lines enabling quadrant-based interpretation. A normalised ESG scorecard employing categorical markers was used to summarise relative performance across indicators, while three-year trends in GHG emission intensity were analysed using small-multiple line charts to capture firm-specific efficiency trajectories. An overall ESG score was derived through aggregation of normalised indicators to provide a composite, diagnostic view of relative performance rather than a definitive ranking.

ENVIRONMENTAL PERFORMANCE

This section examines the environmental performance of selected automobile manufacturers using intensity-based and comparative indicators derived from BRSR disclosures. The analysis focuses on outcomes such as emission efficiency, energy use patterns, and renewable energy adoption, rather than on absolute disclosure values. This approach allows for a more meaningful comparison across firms of different sizes and operational scales, and helps distinguish between structural efficiency improvements and symbolic sustainability actions.

ENVIRONMENTAL–SOCIAL PERFORMANCE POSITIONING

The environment and social performance matrix reveals clear divergence in sustainability performance across companies. Tata Motors demonstrates relatively strong environmental outcomes but lags on social performance, indicating an imbalance between efficiency gains and workforce-related outcomes. Mahindra & Mahindra shows comparatively stronger social performance alongside moderate environmental outcomes, suggesting a more balanced but limited improvement across dimensions. Ashok Leyland occupies a central position, reflecting moderate performance on both fronts, while Maruti Suzuki exhibits comparatively weaker environmental outcomes despite moderate social performance. Overall, the matrix underscores that environmental and social performance do not progress uniformly, with sustainability strategies across the sector remaining uneven and dimension-specific rather than integrated

GHG EMISSION INTENSITY AND RENEWABLE ENERGY ADOPTION

The relationship between renewable energy adoption and GHG emission intensity finds that higher renewable energy share does not consistently translate into lower emission intensity across firms. While Ashok Leyland records relatively high renewable energy adoption, its emission intensity remains higher than peers with lower renewable shares. In contrast, Tata Motors achieves lower emission intensity with a more moderate level of renewable energy use, indicating that operational efficiency, process optimisation, and scale effects play a critical role in determining emission outcomes. These findings highlight the limitations of relying on renewable energy metrics in isolation and underscore the

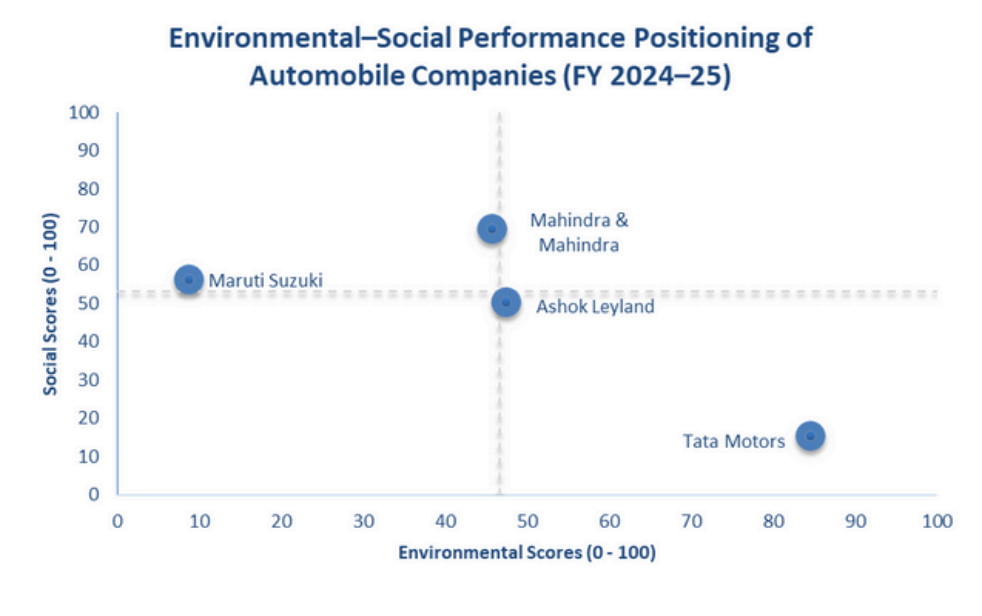
importance of structural efficiency improvements alongside energy transition initiatives.

THREE-YEAR TRENDS IN GHG EMISSION INTENSITY

Across all companies, a downward trend in emission intensity is observed, indicating gradual improvements in carbon efficiency over the study period. However, the rate and consistency of improvement vary considerably. Tata Motors demonstrates the most pronounced and sustained decline, suggesting effective efficiency measures and operational improvements. Ashok Leyland also shows steady improvement, though from a higher initial intensity level.

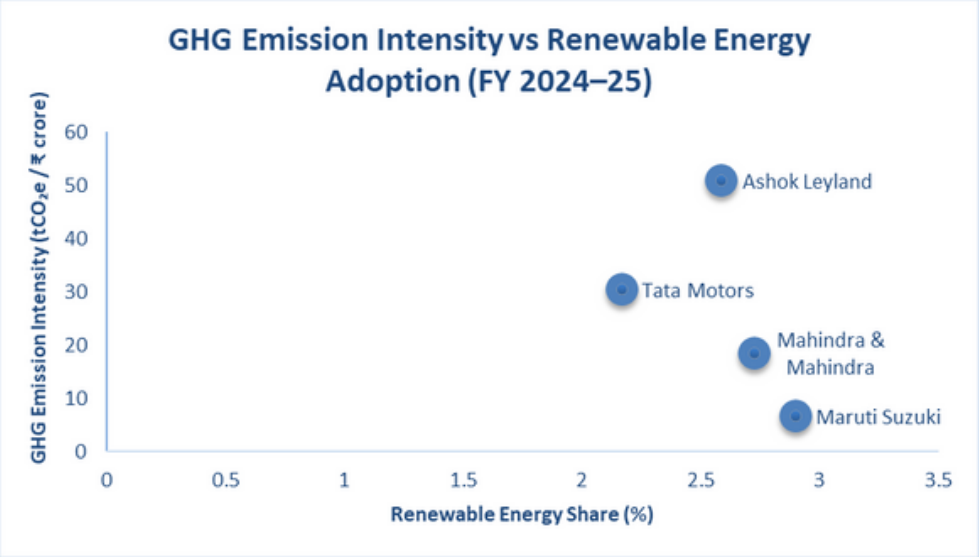
Mahindra & Mahindra and Maruti Suzuki exhibit more modest reductions, with periods of stagnation visible in the trend lines. These patterns suggest that while sector-wide improvements are occurring, the depth and effectiveness of decarbonisation efforts differ substantially across firms.

ENVIRONMENTAL–SOCIAL PERFORMANCE POSITIONING (FY 2024–25)



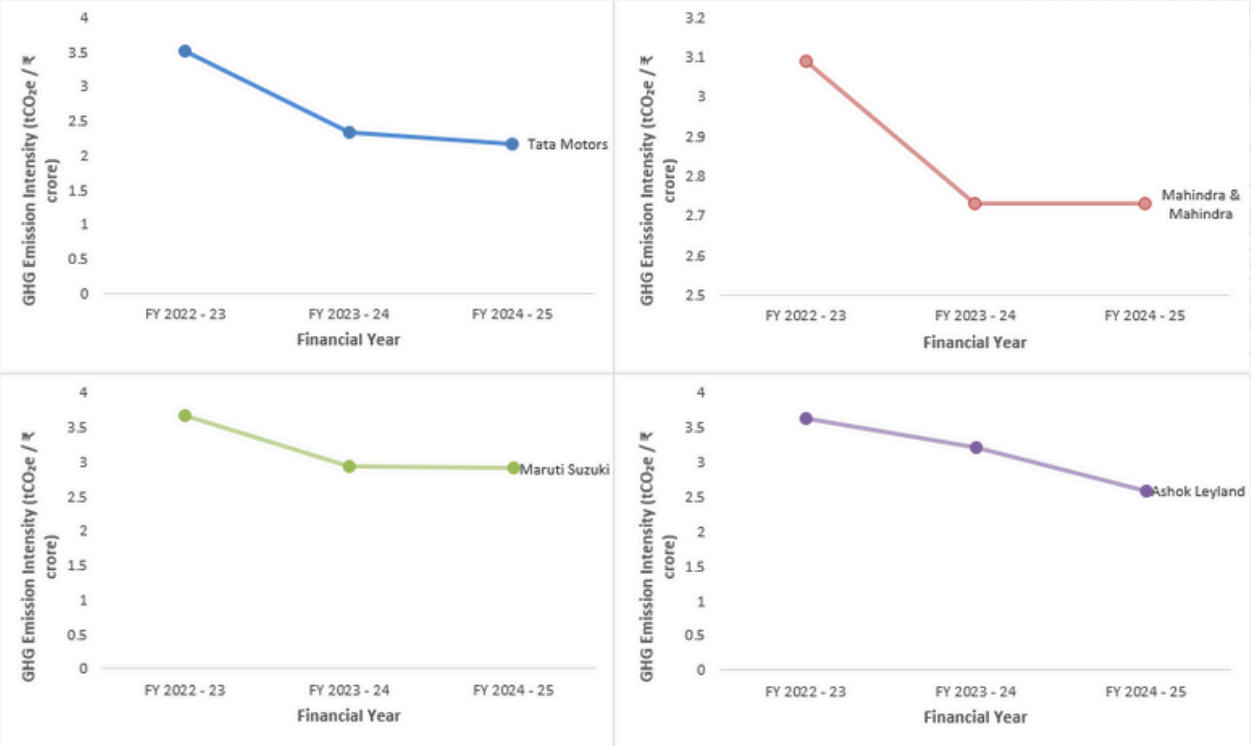
The chart situates firms relative to peer performance across environmental and social dimensions, enabling quadrant-based comparison.

GHG EMISSION INTENSITY AND RENEWABLE ENERGY ADOPTION (FY 2024–25)



The chart compares renewable energy adoption with GHG emission intensity to examine whether transition efforts translate into efficiency outcomes.

TRENDS IN GHG EMISSION INTENSITY (FY 2022–23 TO FY 2024–25)



The chart tracks changes in GHG emission intensity over time to assess the direction and consistency of efficiency improvements.

SOCIAL PERFORMANCE AND WORKFORCE RISK

Social performance within the automobile manufacturing sector is closely linked to operational risk, workforce stability, and long-term productivity. Unlike environmental indicators, which often show gradual improvement through efficiency gains, social indicators tend to reflect deeper structural conditions related to labour practices, safety culture, and human capital investment. This section analyses workforce-related social performance using indicators drawn from BRSR disclosures, with a focus on occupational safety, employee well-being expenditure, and gender-related outcomes.

WORKFORCE SAFETY PERFORMANCE

Lost Time Injury Frequency Rate (LTIFR) is one of the most outcome-oriented social indicators available within the BRSR framework. It directly reflects workplace safety conditions and is particularly relevant in manufacturing contexts where physical risk exposure is high.

The comparative analysis indicates meaningful variation in LTIFR outcomes across firms. While some companies demonstrate relatively strong safety performance, others continue to record higher injury rates, signalling persistent safety risks. These differences are significant because LTIFR outcomes are not solely determined by disclosure practices, but by operational discipline, safety culture, and the extent to which safety standards are enforced across both permanent and contractual workforce segments.

Importantly, improvements in LTIFR are not uniform across firms, suggesting that safety outcomes remain uneven within the sector. This is particularly relevant given the automobile industry's reliance on contract labour and multi-tier supply arrangements, where safety enforcement mechanisms are often weaker. The findings indicate that workforce safety remains an area where compliance-level reporting may mask underlying operational vulnerabilities.

EMPLOYEE WELL-BEING EXPENDITURE

Employee well-being expenditure, measured as a proportion of revenue, provides insight into the extent to which firms invest in workforce support beyond statutory requirements. While absolute spending figures may appear substantial, normalising well-being expenditure relative to revenue allows for more meaningful comparison across firms.

The analysis reveals that well-being expenditure remains modest across the peer group, with only limited variation between firms. Even among relatively stronger performers, expenditure levels suggest that workforce well-being is not yet a core strategic priority when viewed in relation to overall business scale. This raises questions about whether current well-being initiatives are primarily compliance-driven or represent sustained investment in human capital.

The findings also highlight a potential disconnect between environmental ambition and social investment. Firms demonstrating strong environmental efficiency do not necessarily exhibit higher well-being expenditure, reinforcing the observation that sustainability efforts are often pursued in silos rather than through an integrated approach.

GENDER-RELATED PERFORMANCE

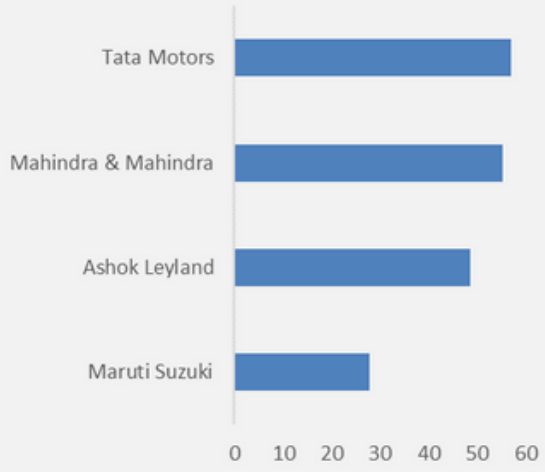
Gender-related indicators within BRSR disclosures provide limited but important insight into workforce diversity and inclusion. In the context of automobile manufacturing, where shop-floor roles are traditionally male-dominated, improvements in gender representation tend to be incremental and structurally constrained. The comparative analysis shows uneven gender-related performance across firms, with no company demonstrating consistently strong outcomes across all gender-related indicators. While some firms perform relatively better within the peer group, overall scores remain moderate, reflecting the broader challenges associated with workforce diversification in manufacturing environments.

It is important to interpret these results cautiously. Lower gender-related scores do not necessarily imply non-compliance, but rather indicate structural barriers that extend beyond individual firm-level initiatives. Nonetheless, the persistence of low relative scores suggests that gender inclusion remains an area requiring sustained and targeted intervention.

ESG PERFORMANCE OVERVIEW ACROSS FIRMS (FY 2024–25)

This page provides a consolidated snapshot of relative ESG performance across firms, combining composite scores with indicator-level outcomes to support integrated interpretation.

Overall ESG Score



Indicator Level ESG Performance Summary

Company	GHG	Energy	RE	Wellbeing	LTIFR	Gender
Tata Motors	🟢	🟢	🟡	🔴	🔴	🟡
Mahindra & Mahindra	🔴	🟢	🔴	🟡	🟢	🟢
Maruti Suzuki	🔴	🔴	🔴	🟡	🟢	🔴
Ashok Leyland	🟡	🔴	🟢	🟢	🟡	🔴

🟢 Strong relative performance (top third)

🟡 Average relative performance (Middle third)

🔴 Lagging relative performance (Bottom third)

INTEGRATED ESG INSIGHTS AND CROSS-DIMENSIONAL TRADE-OFFS

ENVIRONMENTAL–SOCIAL TRADE-OFFS IN SUSTAINABILITY PERFORMANCE

The environmental–social performance matrix highlights that strong outcomes in one dimension do not automatically translate into comparable performance in the other. Firms that demonstrate relatively strong environmental efficiency—particularly in emission intensity and energy use—do not consistently perform well on social indicators such as workforce well-being or safety outcomes. Conversely, relatively stronger social performance does not necessarily coincide with lower environmental impact.

This divergence suggests that sustainability efforts within the automobile sector are often structured around specific compliance or efficiency objectives, rather than being embedded holistically into business strategy. Environmental improvements appear to be driven largely by operational and regulatory pressures related to emissions and energy use, while social outcomes remain more dependent on internal policy choices and organisational culture.

The absence of firms consistently occupying the high environmental–high social quadrant reinforces the view that integrated ESG leadership remains limited within the sector. Instead, most firms display a mix of strengths and weaknesses, reflecting trade-offs between efficiency-driven environmental gains and more resource-intensive social investments.

INSIGHTS FROM THE NORMALISED ESG SCORECARD

The normalised ESG scorecard provides a consolidated view of relative performance across key environmental and social indicators. Viewed together, the scorecard reveals that overall ESG performance is

less about excelling in a single area and more about maintaining consistency across dimensions.

Firms with strong environmental scores often exhibit variability in social indicators, particularly in workforce well-being and gender-related outcomes. Similarly, firms that perform well on select social indicators may lag on energy efficiency or emission intensity. This fragmentation suggests that sustainability initiatives are frequently implemented in functional silos, with limited cross-linkage between environmental management systems and human capital strategies.

The scorecard also highlights that headline indicators—such as renewable energy adoption—do not necessarily compensate for weaker outcomes elsewhere. High performance in one indicator does not offset structural gaps in others, underscoring the limitations of selective sustainability narratives. From an analytical perspective, this reinforces the importance of multi-indicator assessment over reliance on singular metrics.

ESG ALIGNMENT, RISK, AND TRANSITION READINESS

The observed ESG trade-offs have important implications for risk management and transition readiness. Environmental efficiency gains reduce regulatory and cost-related risks, particularly in the context of tightening emission norms and energy price volatility. However, persistent weaknesses in social performance—especially workforce safety and well-being—introduce operational risks that can undermine these gains.

Workforce-related risks are particularly salient in the automobile sector, where production disruptions, labour relations, and contractor safety can have immediate operational and reputational consequences. Similarly, limited progress on gender inclusion reflects broader challenges in workforce diversification and talent retention, which may affect long-term competitiveness.

The integrated analysis suggests that firms demonstrating balanced performance across environmental and social indicators are likely to be better positioned to navigate future regulatory, market, and transition-related pressures. Conversely, firms with pronounced ESG imbalances may face hidden vulnerabilities that are not readily apparent from standalone disclosures.

INDUSTRY-LEVEL RECOMMENDATIONS

STRENGTHEN FOCUS ON EFFICIENCY-BASED ENVIRONMENTAL OUTCOMES

The analysis shows that reductions in GHG emission intensity are not consistently driven by renewable energy adoption alone. Companies demonstrating lower emission intensity often benefit from process efficiency, operational optimisation, and scale effects. Industry-wide sustainability strategies should therefore place greater emphasis on energy productivity and emission efficiency metrics rather than relying predominantly on renewable energy share as a proxy for decarbonisation.

Industry bodies and regulators could encourage more consistent reporting of intensity-based metrics and promote benchmarking of efficiency improvements across firms. This would enable stakeholders to distinguish between structural efficiency gains and symbolic sustainability actions.

ELEVATE WORKFORCE SAFETY AND WELL-BEING AS CORE RISK INDICATORS

Social performance indicators, particularly LTIFR and well-being expenditure, reveal persistent workforce-related risks within the sector. Given the labour-intensive and high-risk nature of automobile manufacturing, workforce safety should be treated as a core operational risk rather than as a peripheral social responsibility issue.

Industry-level initiatives could focus on harmonising safety standards across permanent and contractual workforce segments and encouraging firms to link safety outcomes with management accountability.

IMPROVE INTEGRATION ACROSS ESG DIMENSIONS

The integrated ESG analysis highlights a lack of alignment between environmental and social performance within firms. Sustainability initiatives are frequently pursued in silos, resulting in imbalances that may undermine long-term resilience. Industry-level guidance should promote integrated ESG strategies that link environmental efficiency improvements with workforce development, safety, and inclusion initiatives

COMPANY-SPECIFIC RECOMMENDATIONS

TATA MOTORS LIMITED

Key strengths

Tata Motors demonstrates strong environmental performance, particularly in emission intensity reduction and energy efficiency outcomes.

Key gaps

Social indicators, including workforce well-being and gender-related outcomes, lag behind environmental performance, suggesting an imbalance in sustainability priorities.

Recommendations

- Expand investment in workforce well-being and safety programmes, particularly at plant and contractor levels, to balance environmental gains with social outcomes.
- Integrate social performance metrics into sustainability governance frameworks to ensure that environmental efficiency improvements are complemented by workforce-focused initiatives.
- Strengthen gender inclusion strategies beyond policy commitments by setting measurable, outcome-oriented targets.

MAHINDRA & MAHINDRA

Key strengths

Mahindra & Mahindra demonstrates relatively stronger social performance, particularly in workforce-related indicators.

Key gaps

Environmental efficiency improvements, especially in emission intensity, remain moderate compared to peers.

Recommendations

- Accelerate energy efficiency and emission reduction initiatives within manufacturing operations to complement existing social strengths.
- Leverage social performance leadership to support workforce-driven efficiency improvements, such as training programmes focused on energy and process optimisation.
- Strengthen monitoring of environmental performance outcomes to ensure sustained progress.

MARUTI SUZUKI

Key strengths

Maruti Suzuki exhibits moderate social performance and operational scale advantages.

Key gaps

Environmental performance indicators, particularly emission intensity and renewable energy adoption, lag behind peers.

Recommendations

- Prioritise investments in energy efficiency and cleaner production technologies to address structural environmental gaps.
- Expand renewable energy sourcing in conjunction with process-level efficiency measures to ensure meaningful emission reductions.
- Enhance transparency around environmental improvement pathways to strengthen stakeholder confidence.

ASHOK LEYLAND

Key strengths

Ashok Leyland demonstrates relatively high renewable energy adoption and improvements in workforce well-being indicators.

Key gaps

Emission intensity remains comparatively higher, and workforce safety outcomes show scope for improvement.

Recommendations

- Focus on process efficiency improvements and technology upgrades to translate renewable energy adoption into lower emission intensity.
- Strengthen safety management systems across manufacturing and contractor operations to reduce injury rates.
- Align renewable energy strategy more closely with broader decarbonisation objectives to improve overall environmental outcomes.

LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE SCOPE

While this study provides a structured and comparative assessment of sustainability performance using BRSR disclosures, certain limitations should be acknowledged.

First, the analysis relies entirely on self-reported data disclosed under the BRSR framework. Although BRSR has improved standardisation and transparency, variations in reporting practices, boundary definitions, and data assurance levels may affect comparability. The study does not independently verify disclosed data and assumes consistency in reporting quality across firms.

Second, the scope of analysis is limited to four automobile manufacturers, selected based on data availability and sectoral relevance. While this allows for focused peer benchmarking, the findings may not be fully representative of the broader automobile value chain, including component manufacturers, suppliers, and downstream actors.

Third, the environmental analysis is restricted to Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions. Scope 3 emissions—particularly those associated with supply chains and vehicle use—are increasingly material for the automobile sector but remain inconsistently reported and were therefore excluded to maintain comparability. Similarly, governance-related indicators were assessed qualitatively rather than quantitatively due to the limited outcome-oriented metrics available within current BRSR disclosures.

Finally, the normalisation and scoring approach adopted in this study reflects relative performance within the selected peer group, not absolute sustainability adequacy. A higher score indicates stronger performance compared to peers, but does not imply alignment with science-based targets or best-in-class global benchmarks.

Despite these limitations, the methodology provides a transparent and replicable framework for extracting analytical value from BRSR disclosures and can be extended to larger samples, additional sectors, or more granular indicators as data quality improves.

CONCLUSION

This report set out to examine whether BRSR disclosures can be used not only as compliance documents but also as tools for comparative performance assessment and strategic insight. By applying an indicator-based, peer-benchmarked approach to environmental and social data disclosed by leading automobile manufacturers, the study demonstrates that meaningful insights can be derived from BRSR when data are analysed systematically rather than read descriptively.

The findings reveal that sustainability performance within the automobile sector is characterised by uneven progress and cross-dimensional imbalances. While improvements in environmental efficiency—particularly in GHG emission intensity—are visible across firms, these gains are not uniformly supported by progress in workforce well-being, safety, or inclusion. Renewable energy adoption, though important, does not consistently translate into lower emission intensity, underscoring the continued importance of process efficiency and operational design.

The integrated ESG analysis further highlights that sustainability leadership is less about excelling in isolated indicators and more about achieving balanced and consistent outcomes across dimensions. Firms that prioritise environmental efficiency without parallel investment in social performance may face hidden operational and reputational risks, while firms with stronger social outcomes but weaker environmental efficiency may encounter transition-related challenges.

At a broader level, the study suggests that the next phase of BRSR evolution should focus on interpretability and outcome quality, rather than on expanding disclosure volume alone. For companies, this implies embedding sustainability metrics into core operational and strategic decision-making. For regulators and stakeholders, it highlights the value of benchmarking, intensity-based indicators, and integrated analysis in improving the usefulness of sustainability reporting.

Overall, this report demonstrates that BRSR data, when analysed through a comparative and outcome-oriented lens, can inform more nuanced understanding of sustainability performance and provide a basis for targeted, data-backed improvement strategies within India’s automobile industry.

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DECLARATION ON AI USAGE

This report was prepared as part of an academic exercise and represents original analytical work. Artificial intelligence tools were used in a limited and responsible manner to support the research process, primarily for organising ideas, improving clarity of language, and refining the presentation of content. All data collection, indicator selection, calculations, analysis, interpretation of results, and conclusions were independently carried out using publicly disclosed BRSR reports and relevant regulatory frameworks.

Excel sheet link:
https://1drv.ms/x/c/6807ddaa47004f28/IQADM77PHIoXSIBbKCC6FUHPAQ2kC9kileRxtK-CXHcq_M4